

The Glorious King of Tantras Called the Wheel of the Sun

Śrī Sūrya Cakra Tantra Rāja Nāma · Toh 397 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ཉིམ་འཁོར་ལོ་རྒྱུ་ཀྱི་ལྷ་པོ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ།

The Glorious King of Tantras Called the Wheel of the Sun, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Sūrya Cakra Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal Nyi Ma'i 'Khor Lo'i Rgyud Kyi Rgyal Po, is a tantric scripture belonging to the Vajrayāna tradition. It is Toh 397 in the Kangyur, classified among the tantric texts, and takes the form of a teaching delivered by the Blessed One on the profound practices of the generation and completion stages. The text concerns the non-relinquishment of the aggregates, elements, and sense sources as bases for generation stage practice, alongside the role of symbolic implements, solar and lunar principles, syllables, and the guru's oral instructions as conditions for realization. With its opening invocation to the glorious Great Bliss and its address to heroes or tantric practitioners, the work is clearly oriented toward advanced Vajrayāna practitioners seeking instruction on the arising of the two buddha bodies as the fruit of sealed and unified body and speech.

In the language of India: Śrī Sūrya Cakra Tantra Rāja Nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious King of Tantras Called the Wheel of the Sun.

Homage to the glorious Great Bliss.

A la la ho — heroes, rejoice!

Wondrous, astonishing:

the great generation and completion,

the unrelinquished and the definite —

may the Protector explain these to me.

The Blessed One declared:

First, the unrelinquished is to be explained.

The aggregates, elements, and sense sources

are the causes of the generation stage — do not relinquish them.

The hand-symbols, sun and moon, syllables,

and the guru's oral instructions as conditions — do not relinquish them.

From the samaya of sealing body and speech at the gates,

the fruit of the arising of the two bodies — do not relinquish that result.

From the karma of aversion arising as fierce anger,
self-awareness generated through aversion,
and from washing the body's impurities —
the distinctions of karma are not to be relinquished.

Pullarī, jālana, and so forth;
within, the crown of the head, the top of the skull, and so forth —
the distinctions of place are what is not to be filled in.

At the heart of the māras in the east and the other directions,
the great sacred sites where the feet rest — not to be relinquished.
Know those places as outer and inner:
the distinctions of place are not to be relinquished.

Like the form of gold-transforming elixir,
that which transfers the aggregates and so forth into deity form —
this is the transference, not to be relinquished.

The place of the cause is the heart;
the place of the result is the aggregates and so forth.
Know the unrelinquished as twofold.
That which grasps the aggregates and so forth as illusion —
this is the support, not to be relinquished.

If one has not taken hold of it inwardly,
meditate outwardly on the very nature of suchness.
The straying from suchness is not to be relinquished.

Meditate on the antidote as illusion, unrelinquished.
Regarding the deities depending on the aggregates and so forth,
the essential nature of the three gates — not to be relinquished.
Between the ordinary and the generation stage, two:
one must know the distinction of higher and lower.
The antidote of illusion is not to be relinquished.

The seven purifications and so forth —
the prerequisite is not to be relinquished.

Turning away from conceptuality regarding the aggregates and so forth,
that which abides in the subtle place —
the distinction of location is not to be relinquished.

The entry of the deity form,
and above, the reversal as illusion — these two:

the distinction of transference is not to be relinquished.

The wisdom fire blazes greatly;
that which grasps the aggregates and so forth as illusion —
the distinction of support is not to be relinquished.

In meditative equipoise and post-meditation, all is dissolved,
and everything appears as support and supported.

The distinction of essential nature is not to be relinquished.

That very suchness, illusion, is without inherent existence —
the distinction of antidote is not to be relinquished.

The wisdom sow (Vajravārāhī) is the unrelinquished;
it is held to be the unrelinquished mudrā.

One unrelinquished resembles another —
the distinction lies in the karma of higher and lower.

Aversion is the mudrā of mind; attachment is of speech;
delusion is the mudrā of body.

The distinctions of mudrā are not to be relinquished.

The wheels of body, speech, and mind,
and the wheels of great bliss —
the distinctions of wheels are not to be relinquished.

The first: the wisdom fire of illusion;
the second: the fire that appears as illusion.

The distinctions of the fierce inner heat (caṇḍālī) are not to be relinquished.

The aggregates and so forth stir from illusion,
and the aggregates and so forth are perfectly burned by illusion —
this is the condition for realizing conventional truth.

Stirring from what appears as illusion,
and that very illusion being burned again —
this is the condition for the non-dual ultimate truth.

The distinctions of conditions are not to be relinquished.

Propagating saṃsāra and generating conceptual thought —
this is the activity of mind as conventional truth.

Generating self-awareness without revolving in saṃsāra —
this is the activity of mind as ultimate truth.

The distinctions of karma are not to be relinquished.

These unrelinquished ones are twenty-eight in number,
and are connected with the vase empowerment (abhiṣeka).
The secret empowerment is to be received from the guru's own mouth —
wisdom and gnosis are something other.
The twenty-eight unrelinquished of the fourth empowerment:
self-awareness and the innately born —
the unrelinquished impurity of dharmatā is the cause of the fourth;
the oral instruction of the master's mouth is the condition, not to be
relinquished.

From the burning of the phenomena of beings by the fire of self-awareness,
what remains is the unrelinquished.

The distinctions of the sequential higher and lower are not to be relinquished.

The avadhūtī — not inverted, abiding in its place;
the place and the great place, not to be relinquished.
Determine suchness as outer and inner —
the distinctions of outer and inner are not to be relinquished.

Together with emptiness and subject-object duality,
the transference, unrelinquished: A and Hūṃ.

Without relinquishing the support, as thoughts arise,
when the mind wanders, cultivate self-awareness as that very suchness.
Without relinquishing whatever has slipped away, remain in self-awareness;
withdrawing the gates of the senses — the natural face, not to be relinquished.
Conquering thoughts by the antidote — this too is not to be relinquished.

From the meditation on self-awareness in general,
the eight preliminary and unrelinquished practices, not to be relinquished —
these are to be learned from the mouth of the master.

With regard to the characteristics of the general and the individual,
cultivate self-awareness with transference not relinquished.

From self-awareness with mudrā not relinquished,
the twenty-four enlightened activities arise.

With karma unrelinquished — all the rest
are to be learned from the mouth of the master.

Absence of faith, not relying on a master,
not having found a holy master,
not having relinquished, not knowing the essential nature —

whoever desires the fruit of self-awareness:
those who do not know are veiled by defilement,
like the milk of a serpent as example.

Then the fifteen certainties as well:
cause, condition, and basis,
what is entrusted, sequence, enumeration, and order —
the seven certainties are taught elsewhere.

The certainty of mantra as with and without conceptual elaboration,
the certainty of condition as wisdom, fire, and wind,
the certainty of cause, result, and basis as A and Hūṃ,
the certainty of the four empowerments as higher and lower in their
distinctions,
the certainty of the refuting antidote,
the certainty of essential nature, and the certainty of differentiation,
the certainty of activity — these five:
the certainties that arise from them,
seventeen in all, are to be learned from the mouth of the master.

If one comes to know fully the characteristics
of the unrelinquished and the certain,
this dispels entirely both delusion and the ground of delusion.
All accomplishments (siddhis), worldly and transcendent,
arise from this.

Abiding in form as a lump of clay in water,
likewise transcending form,
abiding in four modes as well —
the tantra is nothing other than certainty.

The tantra abides in the essential nature of the faculty of empowerment.
Therefore, one who desires accomplishment
must please the master with earnest effort,
and must know the essential nature of the tantra, the empowerments,
and the oral instructions pertaining to them.

Without having pleased the master
and without having obtained the empowerments,
to engage in hearing and the rest
will be fruitless and will come to ruin.

Therefore, strive diligently and apply yourself with care.

The King of Tantras, the Tantra of the Glorious Wheel of the Sun, is complete.

This was translated by the Indian paṇḍita Gayadhara together with the translator, the monk Śākya Yeshe.

Translator's Notes

- The term "pullarī" (Tib. རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་) and "jālana" (Tib. རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་) are technical Sanskrit terms from the tantric tradition referring to specific subtle-body locations or practices. Their precise identification varies across commentaries, and no single rendering has been imposed.

The phrase rendered "the seven purifications" (རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་) may refer to a specific set of seven preliminary purifications known in this tantric cycle; the exact list is not specified in this passage alone.

The line རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ refers to the wisdom sow, Vajravārāhī, as the unrelinquished mudrā; the identification of Vajravārāhī here draws on standard Chakrasaṃvara-related iconography common to this tantric lineage.

- The colophon names Gayadhara, the well-known eleventh-century Kashmiri paṇḍita who collaborated extensively with Drokmi Lotsāwa and others; his association here with Śākya Yeshe as lotsāwa is consistent with known translation partnerships of the period.

The "fifteen certainties" and "seventeen certainties" enumerated in the text are a structured doctrinal taxonomy specific to this tantra. The apparent arithmetic discrepancy — fifteen listed but seventeen stated — follows the internal logic of the text, where the fifteen plus additional arising certainties yield seventeen; this is preserved as found rather than emended.

The phrase rendered "like the milk of a serpent" refers to the well-known Indian simile in which snake's milk, though present, is impossible to extract without the proper vessel; here it illustrates that the fruit of self-awareness cannot be obtained without the requisite basis of faith, master, and relinquishment.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.